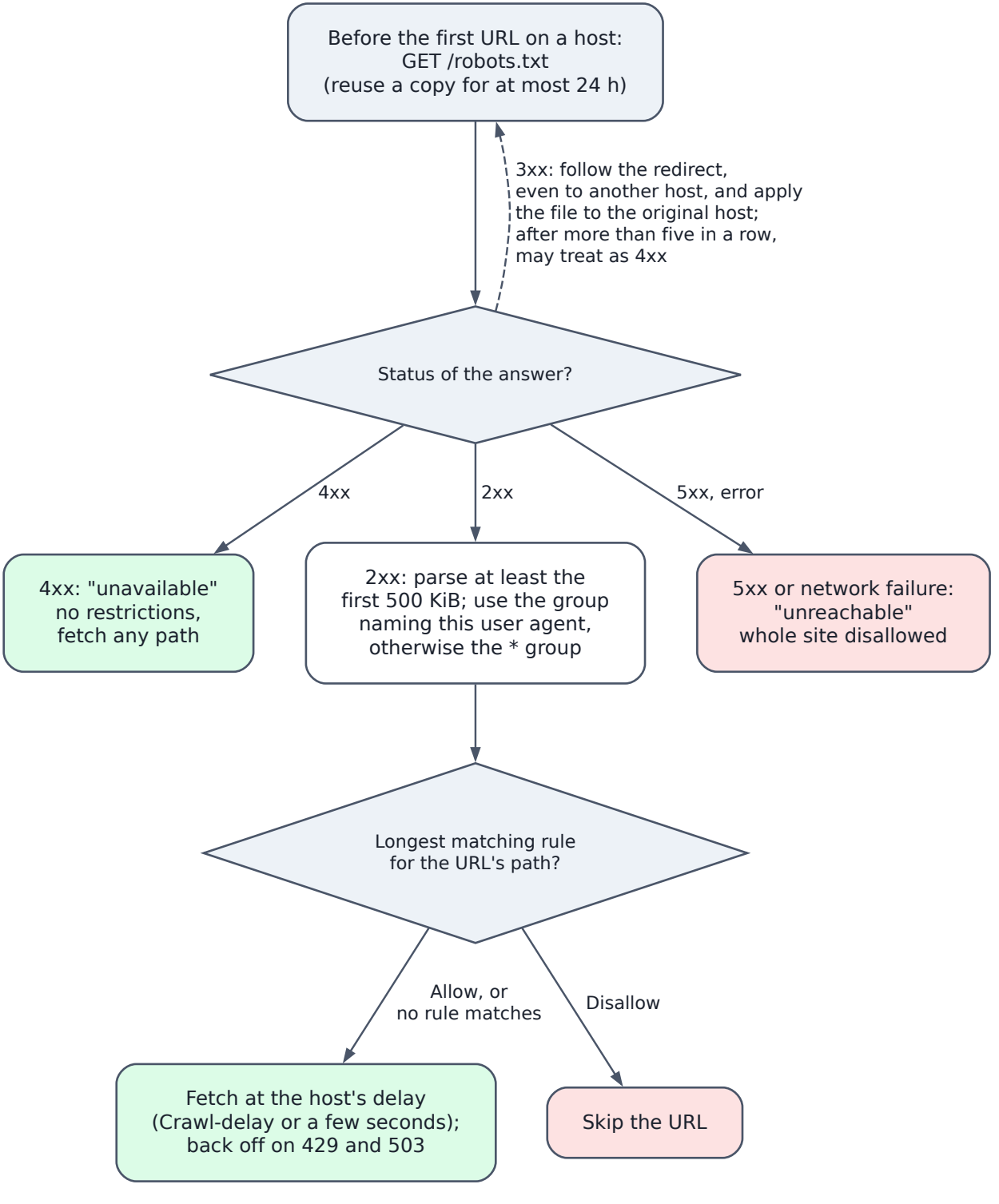
Before the first URL on a host:
GET /robots.txt
(reuse a copy for at most 24 h)
3xx: follow the redirect,
even to another host, and apply
the file to the original host;
after more than five in a row,
may treat as 4xx
Status of the answer?
4xx
2xx
5xx, error
4xx: "unavailable"
no restrictions,
fetch any path
2xx: parse at least the
first 500 KiB; use the group
naming this user agent,
otherwise the * group
5xx or network failure:
"unreachable"
whole site disallowed
Longest matching rule
for the URL's path?
Allow, or
no rule matches
Disallow
Fetch at the host's delay
(Crawl-delay or a few seconds);
back off on 429 and 503
Skip the URL